

HEALTHCARE MANIFESTO



I Had a Dream

Last night, I couldn't shake off the disheartening thoughts of the current state of healthcare in America. Around 1.9 million people die each year due to chronic diseases, accounting for more than 6 out of 10 deaths. People living with chronic and mental health conditions account for 90% of the nation's healthcare costs, which have reached a staggering 5.3 trillion dollars a year. It's also disconcerting to note that chronic diseases disproportionately affect minority groups and the poor. What's most noteworthy is that up to 80% of heart disease, stroke, and type 2 diabetes is preventable through simple lifestyle changes.

I thank God I woke up in peace. My friends, I had a dream. I dreamed of a future where healthcare consumers, providers, and stakeholders come together to end the chronic disease crisis in America.

In my dream, healthcare consumers consider their bodies a gift from God, inspiring them to take ownership of their health care. They partner with healthcare providers to create personalized health plans, incorporating lifestyle changes such as turning away from drugs, limiting alcohol consumption, managing stress, incorporating regular exercise, and eating equally to nourish as for pleasure.

In my dream healthcare providers will be judged by the quality and outcomes of the care they provide, not by the number of patients seen, drugs dispensed, referrals given, and procedures performed. Providers will be ethically inspired to provide equitable care to all regardless of race, origin, income, or gender identification. Providers will embrace lifestyle and food as tools for healing those in their care.

In my dream, healthcare stakeholders will not look to innovation solely to profiteer from the healthcare crisis. Instead, will take on the role of shepherds, guiding us toward a new vision for healthcare. They will invest in research that emphasizes lifestyle health pathways alongside clinical ones. Stakeholders will evolve business models and policies to ensure that access to clean water, nutritious food, and quality care is available to all regardless of where they live. Lastly, stakeholders will shepherd healthcare consumers and providers to the new healthcare vision by incentivizing them to work together for personal benefit, but also the tangible value and common good of being a part of a big solution.

In my dream Healthcare consumers, providers, and stakeholders unite for the collective good to generate exponential value that will radiate through our lives individually and society as a whole. Billions of dollars and millions of lives will be saved. We will live happier lives, longer lives, and have more life in our years.

Last night, I went to sleep with an aching heart, but I woke up with hope.

by Gabriel Braun, June 12, 2021. Statistics updated October 2026.

